

EIGHT OF TOP REDS STILL ARE MISSING

Two Trustees of Bail Fund of Civil Rights Congress Facing Contempt Charge Today

The Federal Bureau of Investigation failed yesterday to report any progress in the search for eight Communist party leaders who are fugitives from justice. Seven of the eight are members of the party's national committee or its alternate national committee.

Four national committee members jumped bail of \$20,000 each on Monday, when they had been ordered to surrender to begin serving jail terms of three to five years. The Supreme Court had just upheld their 1949 conviction for criminal conspiracy to teach and advocate overthrow of the Government by force and violence. The four are Gus Hall, the party's national secretary; Henry Winston, national organizational secretary; Robert Thompson, New York State chairman, and Gilbert Green, Illinois chairman.

Hall acted as head of the party recently when Eugene Dennis, general secretary, was jailed for contempt of Congress. Dennis was one of seven top party leaders jailed Monday for the same conspiracy of which the missing four were found guilty.

Unless the bail-jumpers surrender or are arrested by 11:30 o'clock this morning, two trustees of the bail fund of the Civil Rights Congress face being held in contempt of court. The trustees are Frederick Vanderbilt Field and Abner Green, who on Tuesday refused to tell Federal Judge Sylvester Ryan who owned the Government bonds that the fund posted as collateral for the bail.

Judge Ryan gave them until this morning to decide whether to answer. He also issued subpoenas for the appearance this morning of two other trustees—W. Alpheus Hunton and Dashiell Hammett, mystery writer.

Four of the fugitives have been missing since June 20, when they and seventeen other party leaders, who were arrested, were indicted for a similar conspiracy. These four are James E. Jackson, Southern regional director; Sidney Stein or Steinberg, assistant national labor secretary; Fred Fine, secretary of the party's public affairs department, and William N. Marron, New York State executive secretary.

Jackson, Stein and Fine are members of the alternate national committee appointed to lead the party when national committee members, such as the seven jailed Monday, are unable to function. A clause in the new indictment charges that party leaders conspired to go underground "in case of emergency."

It has been pointed out that the fugitives could go underground either in this country or in a foreign country or might operate openly in certain foreign countries.